

Oliver Stickel

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Experience

University of Stuttgart, Makerspace

Project and lab manager

Stuttgart

2024 – 2025

I helped develop and manage the Makerspace, led a project on sustainability and helped establish a media lab for students.

Ruhr-University Bochum, Makerspace

Deputy general manager / Digital Lab & Plastics Lab leader

Bochum

2020 – 2023

RUB Makerspace is a 2000sqm innovation space full of tools, infrastructure and a team of 15 people. I was responsible for the "Digital Lab" (everything to do with IT and electronics) as well as the "Plastics Lab" (advanced 3D printing, vacuum forming, casting, CNC milling). I also was deputy general manager (project management, staffing, politics, fundraising et al).

Self-employed

Writer, researcher, consultant

Siegen, Bochum, national

2015 – today

Book project "Handbuch Fab Labs" and consultation work for organizations interested in Maker-/innovation spaces.

University of Siegen, research group for CSCW and Social Media

Researcher, lecturer and research/project manager

Siegen, regional, national

2015 – 2019

Academic and management work. Notable projects: SmaP (EU/state-funded, on additive manufacturing), FAB101 (federally funded, on Fab Labs in education), ZEIT.RAUM Siegen (locally funded exhibition project), YALLAH (DAAD student exchange between Palestine and Germany) and CUBES (federally funded, on Usability and Agile for SMEs).

Birzeit University, German Univ. of Technology Oman, Goethe Institute and others

Guest researcher, consultant

Palestine

2014 – 2019

Field research as well as consultations and joint proposals on Makerspaces, education and cultural projects.

Fab Lab Siegen (University of Siegen)

Founder and manager

Siegen, regional, global

2013 – 2019

Founding, funding, management and operation of Fab Lab Siegen, starting as a student initiative with "an old 3d printer and a corner in a storeroom" up to an (ongoing), open and community-oriented space with a funded team, operating hours, more than 250sqm in the city center and a substantial amount of machines and infrastructure.

University of Siegen, University of Duisburg-Essen (CUBES project and others)

Student researcher / TA / assistant

Duisburg, Siegen

2009 – 2015

Multiple jobs as student researcher and teaching assistant (HCI, prototyping, fieldwork, IT support/maintenance)

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Education

University of Siegen

M.Sc., (grade 1.2, with honors)

Siegen

2012 – 2015

Human Computer Interaction: (Socio-Technical) systems design with an emphasis on qualitative methods.

University of Duisburg-Essen

B.Sc., (grade 1.9)

Duisburg

2009 – 2012

Applied Cognitive and Media Sciences: Combination of Computer Sciences and Psychology. Focus on quantitative methods.

Skills

Makerspaces: Development of team, space and safety. **Projects & People:** Team and project development, community building, social innovation, research management, Teaching Makerspace technologies, e.g. CAD/CAM, CNC, basic coding, 3D printing, general tools, electronics, IoT. agility and "Skunkworks" operations within public administrative structures, team funding, multi-disciplinarity. **Public Service:** Procurement, funding, administration. **Human Centered Design:** UX and usability, HCI, Design Thinking, convergence of agile and user centered methods. **Methods:** user-centered teaching and learning, Constructionism, mixed methods, action and field research, participatory design, (Maker-)space as a method. **Languages:** German, English, French (some), Latin.

More

I have been an elected member of different bodies of academic self-governance such as the Senate commission on Strategic University Development at Uni Siegen or the faculty council, as well as head of the student representatives ("Fachschaftsräte") during my times as a student at Uni Duisburg-Essen and at Uni Siegen respectively. I have also served as a work safety advisor at all universities I worked at.

I was reviewer and/or chair for conferences and journals (e.g. CHI or JCSCW, C&T, M&C). Together with awesome people, I co-organized events such as two of the first national conferences for Fab Lab managers at German universities, a lot of different workshops, temporary Makerspaces or the annual World Usability Day Siegen.

At different times in life, I have been a participant/organizer of kayaking groups and camps, worked in hotel kitchens, in retail, in motorcycle workshops and in youth centers, was a Hackerspace member and many other things.

Personal interests

I like reading, cooking, a bit of gardening, camping, being on the water, spending time with my niece and nephew as well as tinkering with a wide range of technologies – old sewing machines and other old machinery, computers and microcontrollers, motorcycles, cars and more. I also quite enjoy being in Makerspaces, Hackspaces, Urban Gardens and similar places/spaces outside of work as a user and community member instead of a manager.

Publications

- My academic publications: https://researchgate.net/profile/Oliver_Stickel
- Full list of publications including PDFs on my website: <https://oliverstickel.de>
- "Handbuch Fab Labs" (open access): <https://www.bombini-verlag.de/shop/handbuch-fab-labs/>
- Old Blog Posts at Fab Lab Siegen: https://fablab-siegen.de/author/oliver_dummy/

Links to some projects I have been involved in

- <https://uni-stuttgart.de/makerspace>
- <https://makerspace.rub.de>
- <https://fablab-siegen.de>
- <https://fab101.de>
- <https://yallah.exchange>
- <https://zeitraum-siegen.de>

Press

- "Deutsche Welle" about Fab Labs and Fab Lab Siegen: <https://tinyurl.com/yy4cwzg4>
- 3D-printing with children: <https://tinyurl.com/yyw4wjsh>
- Refugees at Fab Lab Siegen: <https://tinyurl.com/y3kqo2fb>
- "Deutschlandfunk Kultur" about Makers: <https://tinyurl.com/y3hg2wcj>
- Making@Palestine: <https://fablab-siegen.de/siegener-maker-in-palastina/>

Videos

- Talk during the founding phase of Fab Lab Siegen in 2014: <https://tinyurl.com/y6ng2mzg>
- Video-Tour through Fab Lab Siegen in 2019: <https://tinyurl.com/y6mkbucx>
- Guest Lecture on Socio-Informatics at RWTH Aachen: <https://tinyurl.com/yy8pd2so>
- 3D-printing violins at Fab Lab Siegen: <https://tinyurl.com/yyv7pwgl>